

Warcraft III: Reign Of Chaos

If neither space nor mythology gets you going, and you're more inclined towards fantasy and *Lord of the Rings*-style magical beings, fantasy real-time strategy games are for you. If you like this sort of game, then *Warcraft*, *Starcraft* and *Warcraft III* should be familiar names.

Warcraft III is the follow-up to the older *Warcraft* and *Starcraft* series, and in this version you can choose to play as one of four factions—The human alliance: elves, dwarves and humans; The Orcs: Orcs, Trolls and Tauren; The undead: evil human wizards and their zombie creations; or the elf sentinels, which is a race of fighter druids.

The gameplay is pretty much standard RTS—gather wood and gold, build structures, gather an army and beat your enemies into oblivion. The difference here is that armies are much smaller and manageable, so you have a small bunch of more powerful individuals, and even characters depicted as heroes, who gain power along with experience.

This is typical of role playing games, and we were surprised to find this aspect—of gaining experience as you go along—in an RTS. The result of this mix-and-match is sort of a game that gives you the best of both worlds. The characters are pretty much standard fantasy features, but they're depicted well enough to not make you mutter, “Oh no, enough of the elves/dwarves/orcs/trolls already!”



Warcraft III is the perfect game for those crazy about fantasy games